

Day 4: Power Query Fundamentals & Query Editor

[DEF] Definition to Remember

Power Query is the ETL (Extract, Transform, Load) data preparation engine in Power BI used to clean, reshape, and transform raw data before loading it into the data model.

1. Power Query Editor Interface

- * Queries Pane (Left): Lists all data connections and staging queries.

2. Fundamental Transformation Operations

1. Promote First Row as Headers: Converts top data row into official column names.

3. Query Properties

- * Enable Load: Unchecking prevents staging/temporary lookup queries from consuming RAM in the report model.

[MUST-WRITE] Must-Master Skills & Interview Points

1. All Power Query steps are non-destructive and replayable via the Applied Steps chain.
2. Always filter and remove unused columns as early as possible in Power Query.
3. Understand why explicit data typing prevents silent DAX type coercion errors.

[RECALL] Quick Recall

Extract -> Promote Headers -> Enforce Data Types -> Filter & Drop Columns -> Applied Steps Pipeline -> Load